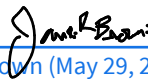


James R. Brown
Jeanne & John R. Blocker Chair in Business Administration
Professor and Department Head

MEMORANDUM

TO: Jing Huang, Assistant Professor, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

FROM: Jamie Brown, Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance


Jamie Brown (May 29, 2025 11:17 CDT)

SUBJECT: Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

Both Texas A&M University and Mays Business School require that the performance of all faculty be reviewed on an annual basis. As noted in the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines, the purposes of the annual performance review include:

- Creating a sound and logical basis for merit compensation recommendations
- Providing evaluative feedback regarding how well the individual is currently performing
- Providing developmental feedback regarding areas where the faculty member's contribution may be enhanced and/or improved in the future
- Providing feedback regarding progress toward promotion and/or tenure as relevant

Further, the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *excellence*;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *effective* performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *effective* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *needs improvement* performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *excellent*, *effective*, and *needs improvement* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *unsatisfactory* performance.

This letter serves as your performance review for the 2024 calendar year. The following reflects information provided in your Faculty 180 submission. In addition, the tenured Finance faculty had the opportunity to review your annual report (containing detailed information about your research, teaching, and service) and current resume and provided me with their assessment and feedback. In the sections below, I first briefly summarize the main contributions you have made in each area, present the assessment of the tenured faculty, and provide my own independent assessment.

Research

Highlights of your research activity during the three-year evaluation window include:

- You have received one acceptance in the *Journal of Financial Economics*, a top-tier finance journal.
- You have two papers that reached the revise-and-resubmit stage at top-tier finance journals. The first paper was conditionally accepted by the *Journal of Financial Economics* in April 2025. The second paper, which is your solo work, is currently at the revise-and-resubmit stage at the *Review of Financial Studies*. You also have four other manuscripts in process.
- You have presented your work at leading academic conferences and top universities. You also have served as a discussant at various reputable conferences.

Teaching

- During the spring semester of 2024, you taught three sections of FINC 381 (FINC 642). Your teaching evaluation scores were at or slightly below the department average. Your course materials, including slides and exams, demonstrate academic rigor.

Service

- In 2024, you served as a member of the PG&E Seminar Committee, where you played a key role in organizing the seminar series. Additionally, you have served as a reviewer for top finance and economics journals and reputable conferences, and you have actively participated in the faculty recruiting process.

Tenured Faculty Assessment

As you will see below, all nine voting members of the tenured faculty rated your research performance as “excellent.” We are delighted that you have one acceptance and one conditional acceptance both at the *Journal of Financial Economics*. It is worth noting that your accepted paper, “*Open Banking: Credit Market Competition when Borrowers Own the Data*”, has already garnered a high level of citations (234 citations on Google Scholar). We recommend that you prioritize converting the conditional acceptance (“*Bank Competition with Specialized Lenders*”) as soon as possible.

Additionally, to earn tenure, it is important to demonstrate the independent ability to publish in leading journals, such as through a single-author paper or a paper coauthored with students or other junior faculty. Your solo work, “*Fintech Expansion*,” is currently at the revise and resubmit stage at the *Review of Financial Studies*, which is great. We recommend that you prioritize converting this paper as well.

Your mid-term review will take place during the fall semester of 2025. Given your excellent research outputs mentioned above, we are confident that you have met the research requirements for the mid-term review. However, please be mindful that your mandatory promotion and tenure review will take place during the 2027-2028 academic year, which is just over two years from now. In addition to converting your conditional acceptance at the *Journal of Financial Economics* and the revise and resubmit at the *Review of Financial Studies*, you will need at least one more publication in journals of this caliber by the time you go up for tenure. Given the long lead time in the publication process, we encourage you to begin getting your other papers under review. While it’s great that you are presenting these papers at top conferences and universities to gather feedback, we recommend that you start submitting these papers, especially the more mature ones, to top-tier finance journals (i.e., *Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, *Review of Financial Studies*, *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*, *Management Science*, and *Review of Finance*) as soon as possible.

You taught three sections of FINC 381 (FINC 642), and your teaching evaluation scores were at or slightly below the department average. Your course materials, including slides and exams, reflect academic rigor. Additionally, you made a concerted effort to incorporate relevant news and cutting-edge research into your teaching, which adds significant value for students.

Nine of the tenured faculty rated your teaching performance as “effective.” To further enhance the student learning experience, we encourage you to consider two constructive suggestions from students: (1) thoroughly explaining course expectations at the beginning of the semester, and (2) explaining difficult topics in a more structured and clear manner.

You served as a member of the PG&E Seminar Committee, where you played a key role in organizing the seminar series. Additionally, you have served as a reviewer for top finance and economics journals and reputable conferences, and you have actively participated in the faculty recruiting process. Your service work is greatly appreciated. Nine of the tenured faculty rated your service performance as “effective.” Please note that we do not expect assistant professors to take on heavy service responsibilities prior to earning tenure.

The tenured faculty regard you as a highly collegial colleague, and we believe the department greatly benefits from your presence. We encourage you to continue actively participating in departmental activities when possible.

Ratings (votes) from Tenured Faculty

Research: Excellent (9)

Teaching: Effective (9)

Service: Effective (9)

As a colleague: Excellent (9)

Overall: Excellent (9)

Additional Comments from Tenured Faculty

- Her research performance is excellent. Happy to see her achievements.
- She is presenting and discussing at many reputable conferences and giving seminars at top universities, which is great.
- Her paper, “*Optimal Stress Tests in Financial Networks*,” was submitted to top economic journals. However, I believe it is time for her to submit it to top finance journals, especially since she will be up for tenure in two years.

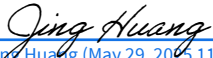
Department Head Assessment

I agree with the assessment of the tenured faculty. You had an *excellent* year. Congratulations on the conditional acceptance at the *JFE* and the new R&R at the *RFS*! You are in great shape for your mid-term review in Fall 2025, but of course your mandatory review in 2027-28 will be here before you know it. I fully support your (aggressive) goal of converting your R&Rs, submitting your working papers, and finishing first drafts of your work in progress. If there is something the department can do to help you achieve these goals, I hope you will let me know!

Your teaching and service contributions are more than adequate for an untenured assistant professor. With respect to service, your extensive reviewing activity for the top economics, finance, and business journals is particularly impressive and noteworthy. You are clearly establishing yourself as a valued voice and thought leader in your area. I am also particularly grateful for your service contributions to the department in the past year, particularly your work on the department seminar series.

Thank you very much for your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

Please acknowledge receipt of this evaluation by signing below. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.


Jing Huang (May 29, 2025 11:24 CDT)
Jing Huang

05/29/2025
Date

Huang 2024 Annual Review

Final Audit Report

2025-05-29

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By:	Lauren Gray (laurenggray@tamu.edu)
Status:	Signed
Transaction ID:	CBJCHBCAABAAAR5KLIS39FWe4o2lxw0pY7AXmMu74fdf
Documents:	Huang 2024 Annual Review .docx (4 pages)
Number of Documents:	1
Document page count:	4
Number of supporting files:	0
Supporting files page count:	0

"Huang 2024 Annual Review" History

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2025-05-29 - 10:27:38 AM CDT
-  Document emailed to Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu) for signature
2025-05-29 - 10:28:37 AM CDT
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2025-05-29 - 11:16:22 AM CDT
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2025-05-29 - 11:17:03 AM CDT
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Signature Date: 2025-05-29 - 11:17:03 AM CDT - Time Source: server
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2025-05-29 - 11:17:05 AM CDT
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